

QB-TimeWarp — QuickBooks Popup Handling Guide

Purpose: Reference guide for handling common QuickBooks popups that appear during SDK operations and testing. Keep QuickBooks windows **VISIBLE** at all times to catch these.

Golden Rule

If you see a popup you don't recognize → STOP and check with the user before clicking anything.

QuickBooks popups can block SDK operations silently. The application may appear “hung” when it's actually waiting for a popup to be dismissed.

1. SDK Permission / Access Request

What it looks like

“An application is requesting access to QuickBooks company data”

or

“Do you want to allow this application to read and modify this company file?”

What to do

- Select **“Yes, always; allow access even if QuickBooks is not running”**
- This is the QBXML SDK requesting COM access to the company file
- If you select “No” or “Deny”, the SDK connection will fail with a COM error

When it appears

- First time running QB-TimeWarp against a company file
 - After QuickBooks updates
 - After changing the application's executable path
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2. Company File Password Prompt

What it looks like

“Enter password for [Company Name]”

or

“QuickBooks Login” dialog with username/password fields

What to do

Enter the correct password:

Company File	Password
Air-Masters-QB-2023.qbw	3825You171
Josh Safty 2021.qbw	3825You171
Blank_Template.qbw (QB21_Blank_Template)	Fl0640098!@!

When it appears

- When opening a company file
- When the SDK attempts to connect to a password-protected company file
- After a session timeout

3. Multi-User Mode Warnings

What it looks like

“This company file is in multi-user mode”

or

“Another user is currently logged into this company file”

or

“QuickBooks needs to switch to single-user mode”

What to do

1. Switch to **single-user mode**: In QuickBooks, go to **File → Switch to Single-user Mode**
2. If another user is logged in, they must log out first
3. The QBXML SDK works most reliably in single-user mode

When it appears

- When QuickBooks Database Server Manager is running
- When the file was previously opened in multi-user mode
- When another application has a connection to the file

4. QuickBooks Update Prompts

What it looks like

“A new update is available for QuickBooks”

or

“QuickBooks needs to download updates”

What to do

- Click **“Skip”**, **“Remind me later”**, or **“No”**
- **Do NOT update QuickBooks during a migration** — updates can change SDK behavior, field schemas, or break COM interop

- Schedule updates for after the migration is complete

When it appears

- On QuickBooks startup
 - Periodically during operation if auto-update is enabled
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5. Registration / License Dialogs

What it looks like

“Register QuickBooks”

or

“Your QuickBooks license...”

or

“Product registration required”

What to do

- Click **“Remind Me Later”** or **close/dismiss** the dialog
- Do NOT start a registration or licensing process during testing
- These dialogs can block the main window and prevent SDK operations

When it appears

- On QuickBooks startup (trial or unregistered copies)
 - After system date changes
 - Periodically as license check reminders
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6. Backup Prompts

What it looks like

“Back up your company file?”

or

“QuickBooks recommends backing up before closing”

or

“Do you want to back up now?”

What to do

- During testing: Click **“No”** or **“Skip”** — backups take time and can interfere
- Before actual migration: **Yes, back up!** — always have a backup before writing to QB 2021
- The backup prompt typically appears when closing QuickBooks or the company file

When it appears

- When closing QuickBooks
 - When switching company files
 - Based on scheduled backup reminders
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7. “Company File in Use” / File Lock Errors

What it looks like

“This file is in use by another application”

or

“QuickBooks could not open the company file”

What to do

1. Check if another QuickBooks instance has the file open
2. Check Task Manager for any running `QBW32.exe` or `qbupdate.exe` processes
3. Close other instances and retry
4. If the file is locked by the SDK, restart QuickBooks

When it appears

- When trying to open a company file that’s already open
- After a previous SDK session didn’t close cleanly
- When QuickBooks crashed and left a lock file

8. “Rebuild Data” or “Verify Data” Suggestions

What it looks like

“QuickBooks has detected a problem with your data”

or

“Would you like to rebuild your data?”

or

“Run Verify Data to check for data issues”

What to do

- **STOP and check with user** — this could indicate data corruption
- If prompted during testing on the **target** (QB 2021) file, it may indicate import issues
- On the **source** (QB 2023) file, it’s a pre-existing condition — note it but don’t try to fix it
- Rebuilding data takes a long time on large files (~360 MB) — coordinate with user

When it appears

- After QuickBooks detects inconsistencies
 - During company file open on damaged files
 - After power loss or crash during write operations
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9. Intuit/QuickBooks Online Advertising Popups

What it looks like

“Try QuickBooks Online”

or

“Upgrade to QuickBooks [newer version]”

or various promotional/advertising dialogs

What to do

- Click **“No thanks”**, **“Close”**, or the **X** button
- These are advertising and have no operational impact
- They can block the main window though, so dismiss them promptly

When it appears

- On startup
- Periodically during use

10. Windows UAC (User Account Control)

What it looks like

“Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?”

(Windows system dialog with dimmed background)

What to do

- Click **“Yes”** — QuickBooks and the SDK need elevated permissions for COM registration
- If you click “No”, the SDK may fail to connect

When it appears

- When running QB-TimeWarp for the first time
- When QuickBooks needs to update COM registrations

Unknown Popups — What to Do

If you encounter a popup not listed above:

1. **STOP** — do not click anything
2. **Screenshot** the popup (or describe it to the user)
3. **Check with the user** — they may recognize it
4. **Read the text carefully** — look for keywords:
 - “access”, “permission”, “allow” → Likely SDK permission (usually safe to approve)
 - “update”, “upgrade” → Skip/dismiss
 - “error”, “problem”, “corrupt” → STOP and investigate
 - “backup” → Usually safe to skip during testing
 - “password”, “login” → Enter credentials from PASSWORDS.txt
5. **Document it** — add it to this guide for future reference

Popup Prevention Tips

1. **Disable auto-updates:** In QuickBooks → Help → Update QuickBooks → Options → turn off automatic updates
2. **Pre-authorize the SDK:** Run QB-TimeWarp once with the company file open and approve the access dialog — subsequent runs won't prompt
3. **Use single-user mode:** Prevents multi-user warnings
4. **Open company files before starting:** This clears password prompts upfront
5. **Dismiss all popups before running:** Open QuickBooks, dismiss any startup dialogs, THEN run the migration tool